

Michael B. Wong

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ACADEMIC POSITIONS

Assistant Professor of Management and Strategy, jointly appointed in Economics 2022-
HKU Business School, University of Hong Kong

PROFESSIONAL AFFILIATIONS

Director, Hong Kong Future Economy Institute 2025-
Affiliated Researcher, HKU Jockey Club ESG Research Institute 2024-
Board Member, Citizen Action Design 2023-
Fellow, HKU Centre on Contemporary China and the World 2023-
Member, HKU Real Estate Lab 2023-
Consultant, Hong Kong Jockey Club 2023-

EDUCATION

PhD, Economics, *MIT*, 2022.

AB, Physics, *Harvard*, 2012. Minor in Computer Science. *Magna cum laude with highest distinction.*

PUBLICATIONS

- (1) “Ideological Bias and Trust in Information Sources” (joint with Matthew Gentzkow and Allen T. Zhang) *American Economic Journal: Microeconomics*.

WORKING PAPERS

- (2) “Domestic Outsourcing and Employment Security” (with Naijia Guo and Duoxi Li) *Revise and Resubmit, Journal of Development Economics*
- (3) “Outsourcing, Labor Market Frictions, and Employment” (with Mayara Felix)
- (4) “The Emergence of Managers in Relational Contracting Markets” (with Duoxi Li)
- (5) “The Cost of Homeownership: Evidence from Subsidized Public Housing Sales in Hong Kong”
- (6) “Money and Barter in the Field: Evidence from a Digital Currency Experiment”
- (7) “Optimal Currency Redemption: Theory and Evidence from a Digital Platform” (with Baiyun Jing, Yang You, and Yulin Zhong)

WORK-IN-PROGRESS

- (8) “The Equilibrium Effect(s) of Rent Control: An Assignment Model Approach” (with Jimmy Ho, Yulin Hong, and Zhongji Wei)
- (9) “The Welfare Cost of Public Housing Misallocation in Hong Kong” (with Jimmy Ho, Yulin Hong, and Zhongji Wei)
- (10) “Housing Policy and Inequality in Hong Kong: A Marco-housing Approach” (with Jimmy Ho, Yulin Hong, and Zhongji Wei)

NON-PEER REVIEWED ARTICLES

- (11) “How Hong Kong can reimagine its greatest asset: people’s homes” (South China Morning Post, 2025-4-5, with Alex Ngau)
- (12) “Anatomy of a Housing Affordability Crisis: Hong Kong, 2001-2021” (Hong Kong Economic Policy Green Paper, January 2025, joint with Jimmy Ho and Yulin Hong)
- (13) “Hong Kong’s economic recovery hinges on having enough adequate housing” (South China Morning Post, August 2024)
- (14) “Hong Kong must stop letting the well-off hog public rental housing” (South China Morning Post, May 2024)
- (15) “The Solution to Hong Kong’s Subdivided Housing Crisis” (Translated from Hong Kong Economic Journal, February 2024)
- (16) “Brain Drain, Brain Gain, and The Future of Hong Kong: Evidence from LinkedIn Profiles” (Hong Kong Economic Policy Green Paper, January 2024, joint with Alan Kwan and Heiwai Tang)
- (17) “Using Data and Algorithms to Reduce Public Housing Wait Times” (Hong Kong Economic Policy Green Paper, January 2024, joint with Shing-Yi Wang and Maisy Wong)
- (18) “What Caused Hong Kong’s Housing Crisis?” (Hong Kong Economic Policy Green Paper, 2022)

NON-PEER REVIEWED ARTICLES (CHINESE)

- (19) 公營房屋改革 會否冲跨私樓市場 (明報, 2025-8-21, 與牛致行和宋恩榮)
- (20) 租置計劃: 從失敗教訓到全民共享 (明報, 2025-7-31, 與牛致行和宋恩榮)
- (21) 居屋二手市場流通窒息 買賣限制須大幅放寬 (明報, 2025-7-3, 與牛致行和宋恩榮)
- (22) 居屋嚴重短缺扭曲社會發展 需大幅擴建 (明報, 2025-6-27, 與牛致行和宋恩榮)
- (23) 現金津貼試行計劃退場 是明智決定——從經濟學理論看補貼轉型的必要性 (明報, 2025-6-5, 與牛致行和宋恩榮)

- (24) 財赤之出路：賣公屋 救香港！ (明報, 2025-4-24, 與牛致行和宋恩榮)
- (25) 香港經濟面臨長期衰退 房策須全面改革（下） (明報, 2025-3-21, 與牛致行和宋恩榮)
- (26) 香港經濟面臨長期衰退 房策須全面改革（上） (明報, 2025-2-20, 與牛致行和宋恩榮)
- (27) 剖析香港住房危機：演變與對策 (香港經濟政策綠皮書, 2025-1-9, 與何漢樑和洪雨林)
- (28) 要告別劏房 絕不能規管起始租金 (明報, 2024-11-7, 與宋恩榮)
- (29) 住房短缺礙引才 政府應續增建屋 (明報, 2024-8-14)
- (30) 加強富戶審查 劏房戶免受苦？ (明報, 2024-5-16, 與何漢樑)
- (31) 香港劏房問題之出路 (香港信報, 2024-2-14)
- (32) 人才得失與香港前景：領英社交資料佐證 (香港經濟政策綠皮書, 2024-1-10, 與關穎倫和鄧希煒)
- (33) 利用數據和算法減低公屋輪候時間 (香港經濟政策綠皮書, 2024-1-10, 與王欣儀和黃美施)
- (34) 香港房屋危機之謎 (香港經濟政策綠皮書, 2022-9-23)
- (35) 預算案 500 億推創科 怎用得其所 (香港經濟日報, 2018-3-18)
- (36) 社會面對新挑戰 須 3 方面調整 (香港經濟日報, 2017-9-13)

RESEARCH GRANTS

- 2025 HKU Jockey Club ESG Research Institute ESG Research Grant Scheme: “A New Dynamic Public Finance Approach to Housing Subsidies”
- 2023 Hong Kong RGC General Research Fund: “Price Spillovers from Large-scale Public Housing: Evidence from Hong Kong”
- 2022 Seed Fund for Basic Research, the University of Hong Kong

PROFESSIONAL ACTIVITIES

Reviewer: *Quarterly Journal of Economics; American Economic Review; American Economic Review: Insights; Review of Economics and Statistics; Management Science; International Economic Review; Journal of Economic Theory; Journal of Industrial Economics; Journal of Law, Economics and Organization; Review of Industrial Organization; Labour Economics*

Invited Presentations and Discussions:

- 2026 ASSA Annual Meeting; AREUEA-ASSA Conference

2025	Kyoto University; ABFER; Society for Economic Dynamics; Summer Workshop on Money, Banking, Payments, and Finance; Search and Matching Workshop in Asia Pacific
2024	HKU Faculty of Social Sciences; Society for Institutional & Organizational Economics; Summer Workshop on Money, Banking, Payments, and Finance; NBER Development Economics Working Group
2023	Canadian Economics Association; GWU; Econometric Society, Beijing; Asian Real Estate Society; Econometric Society, Singapore; Workshop on Relational Contracts; Asian & Australasian Society of Labor Economics; Hong Kong Economic Association
2022	Search and Matching Workshop in Asia Pacific; Virtual East Asia Macroeconomics Seminar; Hong Kong University of Science and Technology (Finance); University of Hong Kong; City University of Hong Kong
2021	Facebook (Novi); Hong Kong Baptist University

TEACHING

2026-	Senior Seminar in Economics and Finance, HKU, Instructor
2022-	Global Management from Economics Perspective, HKU, Instructor
2022-2024	Economics of Organization and Strategy, HKU, Instructor
2022	Industrial Organization II (PhD), MIT, TA
2022	Principles of Microeconomics (undergrad), MIT, TA
2018-2020	Intermediate Microeconomic Theory (undergrad), MIT, TA
2019	Applied Economics for Managers (EMBA), MIT, TA
2018	Organizational Economics (PhD), MIT, TA
2011-2012	Introduction to Computer Science II (undergrad), Harvard, TF

AWARDS AND SCHOLARSHIPS

2018-2022	George and Obie Shultz Fund at MIT
2017-2020	Kuok Foundation Scholarship
2015-2018	National Science Foundation Graduate Research Fellowship
2009	John Harvard Scholar
2009	Detur Book Prize

OTHER EXPERIENCES

- 2013-15 University of Chicago Booth School of Business, Research Professional
- 2012-13 Applied Predictive Technologies, Business Consultant
- 2011 The Greatest Good Consulting, Summer Consultant